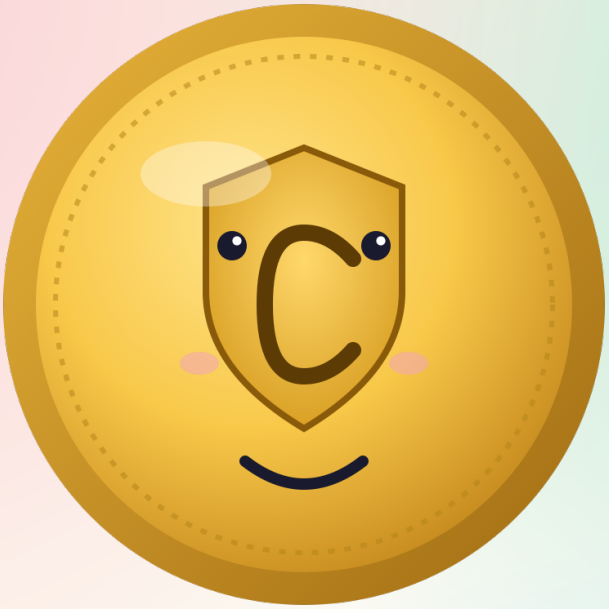


GRADE 2

Curriculum Book

C A S H

Businesses solve problems

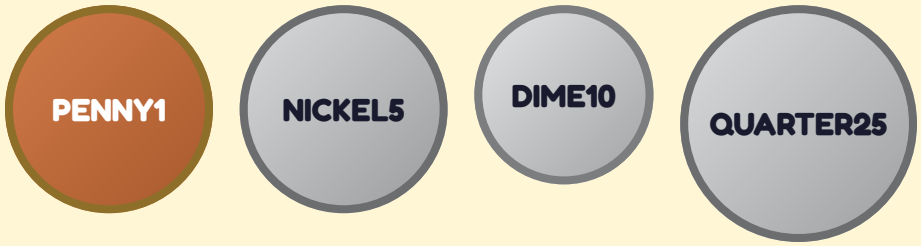
The year, big ideas, vocabulary, and project arc.

Grade 2 — Cash to Company: Curriculum Book

Year theme: Businesses solve problems **Grade band:** K-2 (capstone year of the early-elementary band) **Total instructional time:** ~36 weeks · 30–40 minutes per week (one block, broken into 2–3 mini-bursts) **Anchor mascot:** Cash, the program's animated host

Why this year

Second graders are problem-spotters. They will tell you, unprompted, that the lunch line is too long, that the playground ball is missing, that the pencil sharpener eats pencils, that the kindergartner across the hall is crying. By age seven, the noticing muscle that started in Kindergarten is sharp enough to do real work. Grade 2 is the year we turn that noticing into the program's first true entrepreneurial move: **a problem is a thing a business can solve, and somebody can come up with the idea.**



We do not yet teach pricing or profit. Those wait for Grade 3 and Grade 5. We do not teach plans on paper. That waits for Grade 4. What we teach is the muscle underneath all of that: **see a problem, name a problem, draw an idea, share the idea, and ask one classmate what they would change.** That is the year.

The financial spine moves up one notch from Grade 1. Kindergarten named four coins. Grade 1 counted coins to fifty cents. Grade 2 takes the next concrete step: **make change from a dollar.** A child sells a pretend item for sixty-seven cents; they hand back the right coins from a dollar. It is a real life skill, fully within reach of a seven-year-old, and it lands the year's only piece of harder math.

The classroom spine is the **Problem Wall** and the class-wide Capstone, the **Solve-It Fair**, where children present their problem-and-idea to families and other classes. The fair is the year's culmination — a public sharing of ideas that the children themselves came up with.

Grade 2 is the most sophisticated year of the K-2 band. By June, a Cash to Company second grader can spot a problem, name an idea, sequence the steps to test it, take a role in a small team, write a "fair to the customer" sentence, and tell a classmate what they would change. That is real entrepreneurial thinking, in seven-year-old size.

The big ideas (Stage 1)

Every unit, every lesson, and every Cash video circles back to one or more of these.

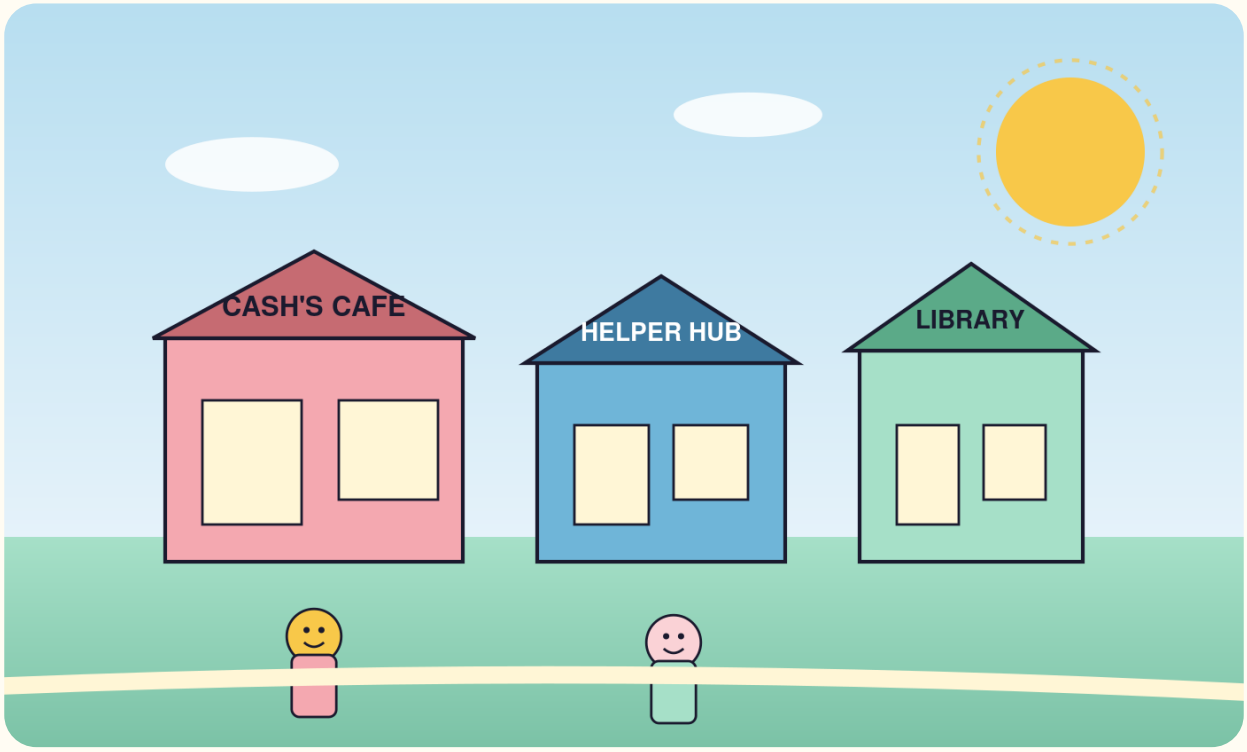
1. **Businesses solve problems.** Where there is a problem, there is room for a helper-idea.
2. **Ideas come from looking.** Real problems we see beat made-up problems we imagine.
3. **A dollar makes change.** When something costs less than a dollar, coins come back.
4. **Signs help customers.** A sign that says "open" or "the line forms here" makes a place easier to use.
5. **Teams have parts.** A boss decides. A worker does. A customer buys. Each one matters.
6. **Fair means fair.** Honest stories, honest prices, honest signs. Fair to the customer is fair to the helper too.
7. **One classmate, one change.** Asking "what would you change?" makes our work better.

Essential questions (returned to all year)

- What problem did the helper solve, and for who?
- What is one problem I see in our school?

- How many coins make change from a dollar?
- What sign would help a customer here?
- What is my job on this team?
- Was that fair to the customer? How do you know?

These questions appear on the wall, on the back of the Activity Book, and at the end of every Cash video.



Helpers are everywhere. Each one is a kind of business.

CASH SAYS

Which coin is more? Show me with your hands.

Year-at-a-glance — four units and four capstones

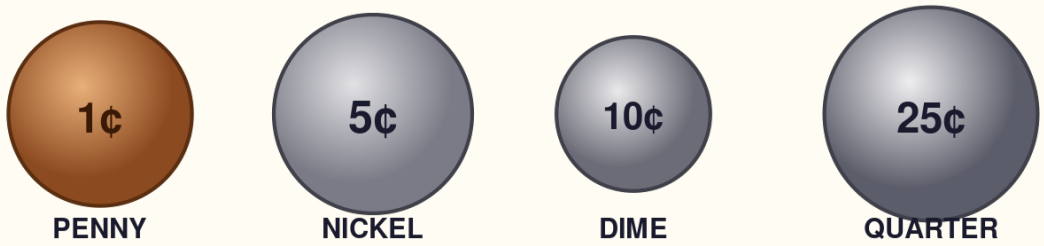
Unit	Weeks	Title	Big idea	Capstone artifact
1	1–9	Problems we see	A problem is a thing a business can solve.	A class **Problem Wall** with at least 20 named problems and a "Problem of the Week" chosen on Fridays.
2	10–18	Coins and change	We can make change from a dollar.	A pretend **Class Market** day where each child makes change for a partner with mixed coins.
3	19–27	Signs, teams, and fair play	Signs help customers. Teams have parts. Fair is fair.	A **Helpful Sign** designed and posted by each child + a 3-role team skit (boss, worker, customer).
4	28–36	The Solve-It Fair	I see, I draw, I share, I revise.	The class-wide **Solve-It Fair** — each child shows a Problem→Idea card and gets one revision from a classmate.

The Capstone is **the Solve-It Fair**, hosted on Family Visit Day in the final week. Children walk a grown-up to their Problem→Idea card and play one round at a class-run pretend store. Each child has, by then,

asked one classmate "what would you change?" and written the answer on the card.

The 8 strand outcomes (verbatim from Master Scope)

By the end of Grade 2, a Cash to Company student will be able to:



Penny. Nickel. Dime. Quarter. We say each name out loud.

- **BAVC** — I can identify a problem (e.g., spilled juice, lost mittens) and name a business that already solves a problem like it.
- **PSIG** — I can fill out a "Problem → Idea" card (problem in my school + one idea to fix it) and share it with a partner.
- **MFL** — I can make change from a dollar for an item that costs less than a dollar, using coins.
- **CBM** — I can draw a "sign that helps customers" (open/closed, line forms here, today's special) and explain why it helps.
- **OSO** — I can use a checklist to set up a "store" station and check off each step as I go.

- **LTO** — I can identify "the boss," "the worker," and "the customer" in a classroom skit and say what each one does.
- **ESL** — I can tell whether something in a story was "fair to the customer" and give a reason.
- **LRCI** — I can ask one classmate "what would you change?" about a product I made, and write down what they said.

Each outcome is named in at least one lesson and at least one Cash video. The Capstone Solve-It Fair touches all eight.

Vocabulary roadmap (12 K-2 terms)

We keep the list short. Words go on the **Word Wall** with a picture next to each. Children point and say. By June, second graders can read most of them.

1. **problem** — something that bothers us or makes a job hard
2. **idea** — a way to fix the problem
3. **business** — a person or place that helps people, usually for money
4. **customer** — the person who buys or visits
5. **boss** — the helper who decides what the team does
6. **worker** — the helper who does the job
7. **change** — the coins that come back when you pay more than the price
8. **dollar** — a paper bill worth one hundred cents

9. **sign** — a picture or words that tell a customer something
10. **checklist** — a list of steps you check off as you go
11. **fair** — honest and the same for everybody
12. **revise** — to change something to make it better
13. **team** — a group of people working together (bonus term)
14. **share** — to tell someone what you made (bonus term)

Standards alignment (verbatim from Standards Alignment Map)

- **Jump$tart Standard 6 (Financial Decision Making), Benchmark 4-1:** Identify the costs and benefits of a financial decision. (Made age-appropriate via "would the customer pay for this?")
- **CEE Standard 2 (Buying Goods and Services), Grade 4:** When buying a good or service, people consider what they want and what they can afford.
- **CCSS-Math 2.MD.C.8:** Solve word problems involving dollar bills, quarters, dimes, nickels, and pennies — center of "make change from $1."
- **CCSS-ELA W.2.2:** Write informative/explanatory texts — Problem→Idea cards practice this.

- **NGSS-ETS K-2-ETS1-1:** Ask questions, make observations, and gather information about a situation people want to change. (Direct fit for "businesses solve problems.")
- **CASEL Responsible Decision-Making:** Identify a problem and propose a solution.
- **C3 D2.Eco.5.K-2:** Identify prices of products, including taxes, that people pay for what they want.

This grade is unusually well-aligned. The "businesses solve problems" theme maps directly onto NGSS engineering design and CASEL decision-making, which makes Grade 2 an easy sell to skeptical school administrators.

CASH SAYS

What comes first? What comes next?

Picture-first design (visual notes for the printed book)

Every spread of every Grade 2 book is at least 50% illustration. Type is large (16-18pt body, 24pt headlines). Sentences are short.

[VISUAL NOTE — cover spread] Cash, the coin-shaped mascot, holds a small clipboard with three checkboxes. Behind Cash: a school

hallway. A child notices a missing playground ball. A child notices a long line. A child draws a sign. The word "PROBLEMS" arches across the top in warm yellow.

[VISUAL NOTE — Unit 1 opener] A class hallway with a big bulletin board labeled PROBLEM WALL. Sticky notes show: "the line is too long," "lost mittens," "the pencil sharpener jams." Cash points and smiles.

[VISUAL NOTE — Unit 2 opener] A child at a pretend store. A dollar bill on the counter. A pretzel with a price tag — 67¢. Coins coming back: 1 quarter, 1 nickel, 3 pennies = 33¢ change. Cash holds up a chart.

[VISUAL NOTE — Unit 3 opener] Four signs hang in a row: OPEN, LINE FORMS HERE, TODAY'S SPECIAL, CLOSED. Below: a classroom skit with three labeled children — BOSS, WORKER, CUSTOMER.

[VISUAL NOTE — Unit 4 opener] A classroom set up like a fair. Children stand at small tables, each holding a Problem→Idea card. A grown-up reads one. Cash, in the corner, takes notes. A sign overhead reads "SOLVE-IT FAIR."

Sensitivity considerations specific to this year

- **No family money probing.** We never ask "how much did your family pay?" or "how much money does your family have?" The

"make change from a dollar" lessons use only pretend coins and pretend prices. **Sensitivity flag:** if a child volunteers something about family money, the teacher receives it warmly and redirects to the pretend scenario.

- **Problems we see vs. private struggles.** When children name "problems in my school," some may name something painful (a friend was mean, a sibling is sick, an empty lunchbox). Receive warmly. Do not write painful private items on the public Problem Wall. Write them on a small note for the teacher only and choose a different problem with the child for the wall.
- **Fairness is loaded.** "Fair" lands hard at age seven. Children may use it to mean "I didn't get what I wanted." Coach the distinction: fair to the customer means honest, the same for everybody, no tricks. The Cash video models this directly.
- **Real coins around small children.** Use rubber or laminated coin cards for daily handling. Real coins appear only with adult supervision and clear hand-washing.
- **Allergies in the pretend store.** Use felt or paper food only. Do not bring real snacks for the Class Market or Solve-It Fair.
- **Family structure.** Family Visit Day pairs every child with a grown-up — a family adult, a teacher buddy, or another family. The point is the telling, not who tells.

Materials and tools (year)

- A class set of coin cards (laminated, 4 coin types × at least 8 cards each).
- A small set of real coins (in a sealed jar, supervised use).
- A small set of pretend dollar bills (paper, 4 per child).
- The **Problem Wall** — a section of bulletin board with sticky notes (refill weekly).
- A class-made **Sign Library** — children's own signs displayed on a separate wall.
- 30 small index cards for **Problem → Idea cards** (one per child + spares).
- Cafe corner from prior years (now repurposed as the **Class Market** in Unit 2 and **Solve-It Fair** booths in Unit 4).
- Cash short videos — eight across the year, 2:00–2:30 each (slightly longer than Grade K).
- The Grade 2 Student Activity Book — picture-first, with light writing prompts.

CASH SAYS

Tell me what they said with their words.

Anchor texts (read-alouds; teacher-selected, classroom library)

- Those Shoes (Maribeth Boelts) — needs, wants, and a problem solved with a kind decision.
- The Lemonade War (Jacqueline Davies, picture-book companion) — competing kid businesses and "fair."
- Last Stop on Market Street (Matt de la Peña) — community helpers, returning to it from K with new questions.
- What Do You Do With a Problem? (Kobi Yamada) — naming a problem instead of avoiding it.
- The Most Magnificent Thing (Ashley Spires) — making, failing, revising.

(Substitute equivalents your school library has. The moves matter more than the titles.)

How this year hooks into the rest of Cash to Company

- **Reaches back to Grade 1.** Grade 1's theme is "Businesses make things or do things." A Grade 1 student already knows that the librarian does (lends books) and the bakery makes (bread). Grade 2 adds the question: the librarian and the bakery both solve a

problem — what is the problem? (Want a book to read; want bread for dinner.) The Grade 1 sort becomes the Grade 2 lens.

- **Reaches forward to Grade 3.** Grade 3's theme is "Business ideas come from skills, hobbies, and needs." In Grade 2, students notice problems in their school. In Grade 3, they connect those problems to their own skills and hobbies and start generating multiple ideas per problem. The Problem→Idea card becomes the Skills + Hobbies + Needs web. The "ask one classmate" becomes "pick the most real-sounding idea."
- **Vertical strands.** Each of the eight strands has a Grade 2 outcome (above). The four units braid them together — Unit 1 centers BAVC and PSIG, Unit 2 centers MFL and OSO, Unit 3 centers CBM, LTO, and ESL, and Unit 4 (the Solve-It Fair) ties all eight together as the year's capstone.

Differentiation across the year (band-wide notes)

Grade 2 classrooms span a wide range — emerging readers next to fluent readers, English learners next to native speakers, children with IEPs next to advanced kids who already make change in real life. The lesson plans break this out lesson by lesson; here is the year-wide stance.

- **ELL students.** The picture-first design carries the meaning. Sentence frames are stamped on every Problem → Idea card.

Children may speak any language with their family at the Solve-It Fair. Vocabulary words go on the Word Wall with both a picture and the word.

- **IEP/504 students.** Pre-printed sticker pages stand in for hand-drawn artifacts when fine motor is a constraint. Sentence frames are stamped on every card. Roles in dramatic play are flexible — a child may stay in one role for a full block instead of rotating, and that counts as a Y on the checklist.
- **Advanced students.** Most lessons offer a "push" — a second idea, a second sign, a manager role at the Class Market, a chosen revision they actually try. Don't pull these students out of the regular activity; layer the push on top.

A note to first-time teachers of this curriculum

You do not need any business background. You need to point at problems and ask, "what could a helper do about that?" That is the year. Cash will do the heavy lifting on the videos. The lesson plans take the pacing decisions off your plate. By Week 12, the children will be naming problems in your school you didn't even notice. That is the moment when Grade 2 starts working — when the teacher learns from the room what to teach next. By Week 36, your second graders will see problems everywhere and have ideas in their pockets. That is the year's win.

CASH SAYS

Notice, notice, notice. What did you see?

Senior expert upgrade pack — Grade 2

Multi-class branching scenario — "The lunch line is too long"

A 5-day arc that moves the class from problem to idea to dramatization, modeling the Grade 2 PSIG outcome at full strength.

- **Day 1.** Whole-class noticing. "What's a problem you see in our school?" Children name. The teacher writes 5 problems on the chart. Today's chosen problem: the lunch line.
- **Day 2.** Brainstorm. Each child writes (or draws) one idea on a sticky note. Stick on the wall. Read each aloud. Ideas might include: order-ahead system, two lines, faster-cashier helper, pre-packed boxes, sandwich-bot.
- **Day 3.** Cluster + vote. Sort sticky notes into 3 groups. Children vote with a thumb-up: which group has the most realistic ideas?
- **Day 4.** Pick one and dramatize. Children play roles: cafeteria worker, hungry kid, idea-implementer. Run for 10 minutes.

- **Day 5.** Reflect on the wall: "Did the idea work in the dramatization? What would we change?" Each child writes one sentence in their journal.

This scenario practices PSIG (problem to idea), CBM (signs that help customers), LTO (roles in a skit), and LRCI (one classmate, one change) — four strands in five days.

Cross-grade bridge — preview to Grade 3

In the Solve-It Fair at year's end, mention to families: "Next year, your child will look at what they're already good at — their skills, their hobbies — and connect them to the problems they've been spotting all year. Grade 2 spots problems. Grade 3 makes ideas from skills + hobbies + problems."

ROUND 2 PATCH — Standards Citations (verbatim)

- **Jump$tart Standard 6 (Financial Decision Making), Benchmark 4-1:** "Identify the costs and benefits of a financial decision."
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By end of Grade 2, a student can: - **BAVC:** "I can identify a problem (e.g., spilled juice, lost mittens) and name a business that already solves a problem like it." - **PSIG:** "I can fill out a Problem → Idea card (problem in my school + one idea to fix it) and share it with a partner." - **MFL:** "I can make change from a dollar for an item that costs less than a dollar, using coins." - **CBM:** "I can draw a sign that helps customers (open/closed, line forms here, todays special) and explain why it helps." - **OSO:** "I can use a checklist to set up a store station and check off each step as I go." - **LTO:** "I can identify the boss, the

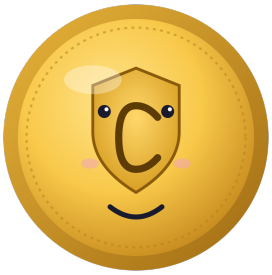
worker, and the customer in a classroom skit and say what each one does." - **ESL:** "I can tell whether something in a story was fair to the customer and give a reason." - **LRCI:** "I can ask one classmate what would you change? about a product I made, and write down what they said."

CASH

Which people, and how do you know?

ROUND 2 PATCH — Advanced-Learner Specifics (Grade 2)

- **Change extension:** Make change from $5 (instead of $1). Same count-up method, larger bills.
- **Sign extension:** Add a "today only" or "while supplies last" element. Discuss whether thats honest or manipulative (seed of Grade 5 persuasion lesson).
- **Problem extension:** Find a problem that no business currently solves. (Hint: "the back row of the lunchroom is loud.") Sets up Grade 3 ideation.
- **Solve-It Fair extension:** Be the "manager" who reviews three other stations and gives one specific compliment per station.



Which people, and how do you know?

— CASH

CASH TO COMPANY

Which people, and how do you know?

Cash is the friendly coin who helps us notice, ask, and try again. Cash will be with us all year. — Grade 2